MODULE 13 · SECTION 2 - GOOGLE CLOUD'S GEN AI OFFERINGS

Search that answers: Agent Search and commerce search

Google-quality search over your own content, prebuilt RAG for builders, and search tuned for selling.

SECTION 2 of 4 EXAM WEIGHT ~35% MODULE 13 of 33

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Keyword search matches words. Agent Search understands **what people mean**, and answers with citations.

Matching words or understanding meaning?

KEYWORD SEARCH

Matches the letters

- "Settee" misses every "sofa"
- Typos return nothing
- Long questions confuse it
- Shows links, never answers

SEMANTIC SEARCH

Understands the intent

- Knows settee, sofa and couch
- Copes with typos and plurals
- Handles natural questions
- Answers with citations

THE SIGNAL

A question that says customers cannot find what they want, though it is in the catalogue, points to semantic, AI-powered search.

Agent Search: Google-quality search over your data

- **Formerly Vertex AI Search;** part of Gemini Enterprise Agent Platform.
- **Searches** websites, structured data such as product tables, and documents.
- **Generative answers** sit on top of results, with citations and links.
- **Multi-turn** and **multimodal:** follow-up questions, and more than text.
- **Easy to add:** a search widget on a web page, or an API in an app.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Search over your own websites and content, built into your own app or site: Agent Search.

What Agent Search does with your documents

01
Ingest
Read files and pages, including scans.

02
Chunk
Split them into passages.

03
Index
Store each passage by its meaning.

04
Retrieve
Find and rank the best passages.

05
Answer
Write a reply, citing the passages.

ON THE EXAM

All five steps come prebuilt. That is why the guide calls it prebuilt RAG with Agent Search.

Ready meal or cook from scratch?

PREBUILT RAG

Agent Search, out of the box

- Whole pipeline managed for you
- Fastest route to grounded answers
- Little ML expertise needed
- Citations included

RAG APIS

Build your own pipeline

- Layout parser, ranking, grounded generation
- Check grounding on any answer
- Vector Search for full control
- More work, more control

THE TIEBREAKER

Fastest grounded answers over company documents: prebuilt Agent Search. Custom control over each step: the RAG APIs, covered in module 21.

Google Search or Agent Search?

GOOGLE SEARCH

The public web

- Everyone's published content
- Fresh facts about the world
- Grounding with Google Search
- Knows nothing private to you

AGENT SEARCH

Your own content

- Your sites, documents, catalogue
- Facts only you hold
- Prebuilt RAG for your apps
- Your data not used to train models

THE TIEBREAKER

Fresh public facts: Grounding with Google Search. Your own documents and catalogue: Agent Search.

Agent Search or Gemini Enterprise?

AGENT SEARCH

A building block

- Developers build it in
- Your website or your own app
- Customers or staff can use it
- You design the experience

GEMINI ENTERPRISE

A finished product

- Ready for employees on day one
- Search, assistant and agents
- Connectors to work systems
- Google designs the experience

THE TIEBREAKER

Customers searching your website, or developers building an app: Agent Search. Employees wanting a ready-made assistant: Gemini Enterprise.

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AI Commerce Search: search tuned for selling

- **Formerly Vertex AI Search for Commerce;** now in Gemini Enterprise for CX.
- **Search and browse** tuned for retail, personalised to each shopper.
- **Recommendations** on the site, in the app, in emails and at kiosks.
- **A conversational agent** narrows broad queries through back-and-forth.
- **Merchandisers** set promotions, tune rankings and handle stock-outs.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> A retailer's product search, browse or recommendations: AI Commerce Search, or Vertex AI Search for Commerce on older papers.

The business value of multimodal search

- **Shoppers often cannot name** what they want, but they can show it.
- **A photo plus a few words** says more than any keyword.
- **Fewer searches** that end with no results, and fewer abandoned visits.
- **Measured in** search conversion and revenue per visitor.
- **Set the baseline first,** so the gain can be proved.

THE TAKEAWAY

Value is shown in business measures against a baseline, never in model scores or feature counts.

Which search product?

THE QUESTION SAYS	CHOOSE
"Shoppers search our product catalogue"	AI Commerce Search
"You may also like, in emails and on pages"	Recommendations
"A search box on our help website"	Agent Search
"Ground our chatbot in support documents"	Agent Search, as prebuilt RAG
"Fresh public facts for the model"	Grounding with Google Search
"Employees search SharePoint and Drive"	Gemini Enterprise

THE TIEBREAKER

Ask who is searching, and over whose content. Those two answers pick the product.

> Shoppers on Wrenfield's website type "comfy settee for a small flat" and get no results, although dozens of products fit.
>
> The e-commerce team wants search that understands shoppers and is tuned for selling.

Which offering fits best?

A Gemini Enterprise

B Grounding with Google Search

C Train a custom search model

D AI Commerce Search

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which offering fits best?

A **Gemini Enterprise**
For employees, not shoppers on the website.

B **Grounding with Google Search**
Brings in public web facts, not Wrenfield's catalogue.

C **Train a custom search model**
Huge effort for something already built.

D **AI Commerce Search**
Retail-tuned, semantic product search and browse.

THE SIGNAL

Shoppers searching a product catalogue: AI Commerce Search.

> Wrenfield's developers are building a customer help chatbot.
>
> It must answer from 3,000 support documents, cite its sources, and launch within weeks, without building their own retrieval pipeline.

What should they use?

A Fine-tune Gemini on the support documents

B Agent Search, as prebuilt RAG

C Grounding with Google Search

D Paste the documents into every prompt

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they use?

A Fine-tune Gemini on the support documents

Slow, goes stale, and gives no citations.

B Agent Search, as prebuilt RAG

Managed ingest, retrieval and cited answers.

C Grounding with Google Search

Searches the public web, not these documents.

D Paste the documents into every prompt

Too large, too costly, and slow on every request.

THE SIGNAL

Grounded answers over your documents, fast: prebuilt RAG with Agent Search.

> Wrenfield's content team runs an assistant that drafts blog posts about home safety.
>
> Each draft must reflect this week's public news about furniture safety rules, with links.

Which grounding source fits best?

A Grounding with Google Search

B Agent Search over Wrenfield's documents

C Gemini Enterprise connectors

D AI Commerce Search

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which grounding source fits best?

A **Grounding with Google Search**
Fresh public facts, with links to the web pages.

B **Agent Search over Wrenfield's documents**
Wrenfield's own documents hold no public news.

C **Gemini Enterprise connectors**
Reach company systems, not public news.

D **AI Commerce Search**
Searches products, not news.

THE SIGNAL

Fresh public facts: Grounding with Google Search.

> Wrenfield wants a search box on its public help centre website.
>
> Customers should type questions and get short answers drawn from the help articles, with links to each article.

Which offering fits best?

A Gemini Enterprise

B Google Search

C Agent Search, added to the help centre

D Gemini Notebook

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which offering fits best?

A Gemini Enterprise

Built for employees, not customers on a public site.

B Google Search

Searches the whole web, not just the help articles.

C Agent Search, added to the help centre

Website search with cited, generative answers.

D Gemini Notebook

A notebook for people, not a website search box.

THE SIGNAL

A search box on your own website, for customers: Agent Search.

> Wrenfield's marketing team wants product suggestions personalised to each customer.
>
> They should appear on product pages and in emails, and be tuned to raise revenue per session.

Which offering fits best?

A A Gem in the Gemini app

B Recommendations from AI Commerce Search

C Gemini in Gmail

D Clustering, plus fixed rules

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which offering fits best?

A A Gem in the Gemini app

A personal assistant. It cannot serve shoppers.

B Recommendations from AI Commerce Search

Personalised, tuned to business goals, across channels.

C Gemini in Gmail

Helps staff write email, not choose products.

D Clustering, plus fixed rules

Coarse groups, not personal, and not tuned to revenue.

THE SIGNAL

Personalised product suggestions across channels: recommendations.

> Wrenfield plans to let shoppers search with a photo and a few words, such as a picture of their sofa and "matching cushions".
>
> The finance director asks how the value will be proved.

Which measure should the leader propose?

A How many AI models the search uses

B The model's score on a public benchmark

C How many photos shoppers upload

D Search conversion and revenue per visitor, against a baseline

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which measure should the leader propose?

A How many AI models the search uses
Says nothing about customers or revenue.

B The model's score on a public benchmark
A technical score, not a business result.

C How many photos shoppers upload
Shows usage, not value.

D Search conversion and revenue per visitor, against a baseline
Business results, compared with before the launch.

THE TAKEAWAY

Prove value with business measures against a baseline.

Module 13 in five lines

- Agent Search, formerly Vertex AI Search: Google-quality search over your content.
- It is prebuilt RAG: ingest, chunk, index, retrieve, answer with citations.
- Google Search covers the public web; Agent Search covers your own content.
- AI Commerce Search: retail search, browse, recommendations and a shopping agent.
- Prove the value in conversion and revenue, against a baseline.